





department launched the Punia Ahilyadevi Holkar Rural Pilgrimage and Tourist Site Development Scheme. Minister Girish Mahajan aims to develop sites like the Kashi Vishwanath Corridor. The budget for Class B pilgrimage sites increased from ₹2 crore to ₹5 crore, with 159 sites receiving Class C status from 2022 to 2024. Major sites received ₹25 crore, with projects for the Shri Sant Sewalal Maharaj Institution in Washim allocated ₹397 crore.

Pilgrimage Management: Government Measures for Ashadhi Pilgrimages

For the Ashadhi Pilgrimage processions from 2022 to 2024, the Maharashtra government provided clean drinking water, temporary sanitation facilities, health services, and accommodation. A record ₹77.71 crore was allocated, with funds provided for all main processions. Rural Development Minister Girish Mahajan personally oversaw the planning in Pandharpur, ensuring the pilgrimage was clean, green, and healthy.

New Scheme for Banjara/Laman Tanda Prosperity: ₹500 Crore Budget

The Maharashtra government launched the Sant Sewalal Maharaj Banjara - Laman Tanda Prosperity Scheme on February 23, 2024, aiming to integrate 2-2.5 million Banjara/Laman communities into mainstream development. The scheme focuses on improving living standards and economic independence by providing village status,
establishing Gram Panchayats, and relaxing the requirement of a 3 km distance between two villages for creating separate Gram Panchayats. A budget of ₹500 crore is allocated, with ₹30 lakh per tanda approved.

Under the visionary leadership of Girish Mahajan, Maharashtra's rural landscape has been significantly reshaped through comprehensive development schemes. His focus on empowering women, improving infrastructure, and enhancing skill development has laid a strong foundation for sustained growth. As these initiatives continue to evolve, they promise to elevate living standards, foster economic opportunities, and drive holistic progress in rural Maharashtra, ensuring a vibrant and prosperous future for its communities.

